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government's responsibility, the Maoist menace—be it in West Bengal, Orissa, Jharkhand, Bihar or Chhattisgarh—is not comparable to commonplace law and order problems. Fighting the Maoists is no less than fighting a war.

J. AKSHOBHYA,

Mysore

Nandigram, Singur and now Lalgurh have been the signposts taking the CPI(M) on a road to nowhere. The likes of Yechurys, Bardhans, Rajas and Karats thought flaunting their moth-eaten ideology would win them popularity but it only managed to bore. Probably, it is the case of the mass Stockholm syndrome which came about because the workers were subjected to misery for years. As a result, they developed a love-hate relationship with their masters. The recent happenings have broken the spell and it is payback time now.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,

Mysore

Hope Floats

BRPNNL Chairman Pratyaya Amrit has shown the path of delivering and posting profits to all government undertakings ("Bridging the Gap", July 6). The main reason for Amrit's success is the application of basic management principles like motivation, reward, organising, planning and empowerment. In

a state like Bihar, it is heartening to see professionals like Amrit. One hopes that with the chief minister's support, many more corporations in the state will turn around and many Amrits will come out of their hiding.

BHASKAR BHATTACHARYA,

via www.indiatoday.in

Down But Not Out

The BJP has always been projected as a party with conservative dogmas

their share of advantages. Election 2009 wasn't a debacle for the BJP; one can say that the Congress won its votes back from regional parties.

MALA VERMA, *Kanpur*

Call of Wisdom

Kudos to the chief justice of the Gujarat High Court, K. S. Radhakrishnan, for taking the initiative to weed out corruption in the state's judicial system ("Judges on Trial", June



Opportunistic politicians and diffident Central and state governments constitute a conjunction suited to a mutinous conduct by those intent on exploiting the disadvantaged.

BISHAN SAHAI, www.indiatoday.in

("The Lotus Eaters", June 29). In the interest of the nation, one must be conservative. Popular measures have led us to a state where governments cannot take any bold decision. With the majority divided into caste and creed, the Mulayams, Mayawatis and Lalus are enjoying

29). One hopes that other high courts would follow the lead. At the same time, it is also important to ensure that the morally upright lawyers and judges, who dare to take on the high and mighty, are not framed with false charges.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,

Thiruvananthapuram

Distasteful Controversy

As Presidential communiqués go, the one that emanated from Rashtrapati Bhavan at 12.40 p.m. on August 22 was a model of brevity: "In exercise of the powers conferred upon me by sub-clause (b) of clause (2) of Article 85 of the Constitution, I hereby dissolve the Lok Sabha." But by virtue of that bald, 26-word statement, President Sanjiva Reddy, 66, inadvertently opened the floodgates of an unseemly controversy—a controversy that eventually dragged the "highest office in the land" down into the slush churned up by India's current political turmoil. The reaction to Reddy's decision was as swift and savage as the events that precipitated it.

Supporters of Jagjivan Ram, the wily Janata Party leader who had expected to replace Charan Singh as prime minister, immediately called for the President's impeachment—the first time in India's turbulent political history that such a step had even been contemplated. **by Dilip Bobb**



SANJIVA REDDY

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